

Downtown Historic Placemaking Project Overview & Comments from City of Cheyenne Planning Commission

PROJECT OVERVIEW

The 40 Placemaking strategies contained in the *Historic Placemaking: Strategies for Invigorating Downtown Cheyenne* document reflect information and ideas contributed by 428 Cheyenne and Laramie County citizens who attended 107 meetings. These included one-on-one sessions with the consultants as well as the eight public gatherings that took place at The Plains Hotel, the Depot and the main downtown branch of the Laramie County Library System.

The consultants gathered insights by attending three regular City Council sessions, interviewing six City Council members and having the opportunity to meet with Mayor Kaysen on five occasions. One additional City Council work session was devoted specifically to Placemaking.

Elaine Carmichael and Tom Gallaher attended four Downtown Development Authority Board meetings. Christie DePoorter, DDA's Executive Director, arranged three additional meetings outside of the Board's regular monthly schedule. The consultants also enjoyed two days with Mayor Kaysen, Christie DePoorter and Matt Ashby visiting four established National Main Street communities in Delaware and Maryland.

At the invitation of the Cheyenne Historic Preservation Board, the consultants attended three of their regular meetings as well as the Board's strategic planning retreat in July 2012.

In addition to numerous meetings at City Hall, the City and/or DDA hosted 22 meetings at The Plains Hotel, 12 at The Depot and nine at the main branch of LCLS. Most other sessions were conducted on-site with merchants, property owners, office tenants and downtown residents.

Elaine Carmichael and Tom Gallaher spent 66 productive person-days in Cheyenne. Urged on by many Placemaking participants, they also visited Laramie and Fort Collins.

Elaine and Tom were pleased with offerings at 23 downtown Cheyenne restaurants. All local room-nights were spent in downtown Cheyenne at either The Plains Hotel or the Nagle Warren Mansion Bed & Breakfast.

COMMENTS FROM PLANNING COMMISSION

The City of Cheyenne Planning Commission held a Public Meeting following a 45-day advertised comment period on November 19, 2012, to accept public comments on the Placemaking report. The Planning Commission then acknowledged receipt of the report

as a working plan for downtown Cheyenne, and recommended the report proceed to the City Council with the following comments:

1. Question was asked if DDA has the funds and manpower to achieve the expectations of the 20 strategy items listed under their purview in the report. It was noted that these efforts will require partnerships between a variety of agencies and organizations, including the City, DDA, Cheyenne Historic Preservation Board, MPO and others. Funding may need to be allocated and/or leveraged cooperatively with various funding sources, to be determined. The strategies are designed to include the participation and assistance of downtown stakeholders and interested citizens as well. Staff noted that the costs have been provided as an estimate to help in budgeting should specific strategies be considered and pursued.
2. Question was asked regarding Strategy Number 34 to “Proclaim a ‘Motor Court’ National Register Historic District on West Lincolnway/US 30,” asking about the timing for implementation and associated cost values. It was agreed that staff would reevaluate the strategy, and upon doing so, the strategy was removed and can be reconsidered at a future date, if desired.
3. Question was asked if the Placemaking report will become a regulatory document, and staff noted that it will not be adopted as a regulatory document.
4. Staff noted that each organization listed in the strategies will be encouraged to prioritize two to three projects each year in their efforts to address the strategies.
5. The meeting was opened to accept public comment and none was received.